

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



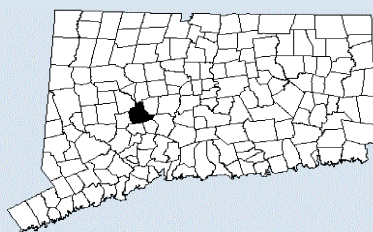
Waterbury School District

Dr. Verna Ruffin, Superintendent • 203-574-8004 • www.waterbury.k12.ct.us

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	59
Enrollment	18,660
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,551
Total Expenditures ¹	\$309,642,878

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	9,011	48.3	48.5
Male	9,649	51.7	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	293	1.6	5.1
Black or African American	3,969	21.3	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	11,284	60.5	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	712	3.8	4.3
White	2,297	12.3	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	3,188	17.1	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	13,203	70.8	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	3,639	19.5	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	3,315	38.6	1,067	11.1
Male	3,714	40.5	1,596	15.4
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0	*
Black or African American	1,500	38.8	787	18.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	4,513	42.1	1,518	12.6
White	632	29.4	208	8.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,290	38.9	370	10.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	5,680	42.5	2,310	15.9
Students with Disabilities	1,688	48.0	780	18.6
District	7,029	39.5	2,663	13.4
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 9,821

Number of school-based arrests: 235

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	1,124.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	86.9
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	189.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	344.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	29.0
School Level	84.4
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	27.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	60.6
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	108.4
School Nurses	30.2
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	711.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	2	0.1	0.1
Asian	29	1.8	1.3
Black or African American	76	4.7	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	146	9.0	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	11	0.7	0.2
White	1,362	83.7	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.7	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	186	77.5	247	83.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	458	76.2	523	84.6
White	116	76.3	159	85.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	104	69.3	133	82.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	655	80.1	811	86.9
Students with Disabilities	156	74.3	237	84.0
District	791	76.6	978	84.7
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	144	37.3
Emotional Disturbance	65	28.1
Intellectual Disability	18	16.1
Learning Disability	1,022	68.0
Other Health Impairment	383	62.3
Other Disabilities	28	21.4
Speech/Language Impairment	359	84.7
District	2,019	59.3
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	396	2.2	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	232	1.3	1.1
Intellectual Disability	112	0.6	0.6
Learning Disability	1,506	8.2	6.1
Other Health Impairment	616	3.4	3.3
Other Disabilities	318	1.7	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	439	2.4	1.9
All Disabilities	3,619	19.8	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	141	3.9	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	140	3.9	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$188,275,762	\$10,064	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$8,935,413	\$486	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$43,905,715	\$2,390	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$8,236,992	\$448	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$15,192,774	\$827	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$2,006,135	\$109	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$18,534,985	\$1,009	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$13,055,815	\$1,201	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$11,499,286	\$626	\$170
Total	\$309,642,878	\$16,551	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$19,199,743	28.6	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	.	.	10.8
Other Salaries	\$12,780,408	19.0	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$15,861,947	23.6	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$4,671,835	7.0	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$8,108,783	12.1	22.6
Supplies	\$490,896	0.7	0.6
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$6,017,309	9.0	6.3
Equipment	\$16,970	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$848	0.0	0.1
Total	\$67,148,739	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		21.7	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	28.0
State	59.9
Federal	11.7
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	19	*
Asian	115	63.6	115	55.1	52	55.0
Black or African American	1,884	49.9	1,876	39.8	767	44.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5,202	49.7	5,174	41.1	2,095	45.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	343	53.5	345	44.1	123	50.4
White	1,083	59.6	1,077	50.3	438	54.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,746	43.8	1,740	37.5	640	41.4
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	6,931	53.2	6,897	43.6	2,854	48.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	7,229	50.0	7,194	40.9	2,945	46.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,448	57.8	1,443	49.3	549	51.7
Students with Disabilities	1,771	38.0	1,759	29.4	700	35.2
Students without Disabilities	6,906	54.7	6,878	45.6	2,794	50.1
High Needs	7,650	49.7	7,614	40.8	3,101	45.9
Non-High Needs	1,027	63.5	1,023	54.0	393	56.5
District	8,677	51.3	8,637	42.3	3,494	47.1

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	78.2	79.7	79.6	71.2	5,507	77.3
Curl Up	80.5	70.8	69.0	58.2	5,507	70.1
Push Up	68.8	54.5	50.2	40.3	5,507	54.0
Mile Run/PACER	71.5	51.8	37.3	29.4	5,507	48.2
All Tests - District	49.7	33.8	26.3	15.8	5,507	32.0
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	284	85.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	582	80.9
White	206	87.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	159	79.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	960	81.9
Students with Disabilities	233	63.5
District	1,131	83.6
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	93.8	234	21.7
Male	90.9	140	12.6
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	90.1	86	16.1
Hispanic or Latino	92.2	139	11.4
White	95.9	115	34.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	89.1	11	3.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	93.4	262	15.0
Students with Disabilities	78.7	10	2.0
District	92.3	374	17.1
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	56.1	75.9
Male	35.1	64.6
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	51.0	70.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	38.6	65.4
White	51.0	81.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	25.0	73.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	43.9	71.4
Students with Disabilities	19.7	52.9
District	45.9	71.9
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	51.3	75	34.2	50	68.4	64.2
	High Needs Students	49.7	75	33.1	50	66.3	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	42.3	75	28.2	50	56.4	58.6
	High Needs Students	40.8	75	27.2	50	54.3	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	47.1	75	31.4	50	62.8	61.4
	High Needs Students	45.9	75	30.6	50	61.2	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	58.6%	100%	58.6	100	58.6	60.4%
	High Needs Students	58.0%	100%	58.0	100	58.0	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	54.6%	100%	54.6	100	54.6	65.2%
	High Needs Students	54.1%	100%	54.1	100	54.1	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	57.5%	100%	28.7	50	57.5	64.9%
	Oral	48.8%	100%	24.4	50	48.8	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	39.5%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	23.7%
	High Needs Students	41.8%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	80.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	17.1%	75%	11.4	50	22.8	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		79.9%	94%	42.5	50	85.0	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		83.6%	94%	89.0	100	89.0	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		85.2%	94%	90.7	100	90.7	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		45.9%	75%	61.2	100	61.2	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		100.0% 32.0%	75%	21.3	50	42.7	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		46.4%	60%	38.7	50	77.4	52.4%
Accountability Index				868.0	1450	59.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	63.5	49.7	13.8	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	54.0	40.8	13.2	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	56.5	45.9	10.6	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	73.9%	85.2%	-11.3%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	98.5
Math	All Students	98.2
	High Needs Students	98.1
Science	All Students	97.6
	High Needs Students	97.6

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 41.3

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Waterbury School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Waterbury Public Schools (WPS) implemented a strategic operating plan, setting the direction for the next eight years. The district has made the following efforts, including plans for the upcoming year: -Hired school counselors at all elementary schools and is finalizing a school counseling curriculum for implementation in the upcoming school year.

-Established a Waterbury Promise Scholarship Program, funding postsecondary education to --Finalizing the partnership with Sandy Hook Promise to utilize their Sandy Hook Say Something Anonymous Reporting System (SS-ARS). -DESSA universal screener piloted at Driggs, Wilson, Bunker, and Tinker to expand to our remaining Elementary Schools, State St, and Enlightenment. -Panorama universal screener piloted at Commissioner Network schools; provides teachers access to embedded SEL interventions - continues. -CIT for Youth Social Workers connects families to care and aimed at reducing the number of students with mental health challenges being arrested. -Director of College and Career Readiness, Director of Equity and Inclusion, and Supervisor of Special Education assigned to Pupil Services, collectively, have defined their roles regarding MTSS components in the district (SEL, PBIS, Restorative Practices, etc.); have begun work on draft of a MTSS framework in-district. -Worked with several community partners to provide services to students that addressed trauma, connected students to services and provided students and staff with support.

WPS Special Education Department, under the direction of a new Director of Pupil Services, has developed a strategic plan to address the target areas outlined in the independent evaluation report and ultimately improve special education programs and services for students with disabilities. The Special Education Department will be restructured to allow designated supervisors to focus on supporting district schools, or specific specialized programs PK-12 or pupil services. Our department provided input to the district facilities study, which will be critical in providing potential possibilities to expand the growing needs in our specialized programs for preschool, autism, behavior, and transition services. In addition, our department participated in the CT-SEDS pilot study this year and will be focusing on implementing this new electronic IEP platform during the next school year, along with IEP Quality Training for all special education and related services staff in our district.

The Learner Engagement Attendance Program, or LEAP, was implemented in the district in July 2021. Using the Parent-Teacher Home Visitors Model, the program was initially piloted in seven schools based on attendance data from the 2020-2021 academic year. The pilot schools included Crosby, Wilby, West Side, Wallace, Bucks Hill, Sprague, and Washington. Initially, each school created a team of four to eight engagement specialists committed to completing phone calls, establishing appointments, and implementing home visits in an effort to identify barriers in getting students to school on a consistent basis. Connection to resources, as outlined in the resource guide, is imperative to the collaboration with families, in an effort to eliminate barriers to students attending school daily. The option of home visits being virtual or in the community was also a benefit to the program.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

District students and staff represent many racial, ethnic, and cultural backgrounds. Students from diverse backgrounds interact with each other at all schools. The district and schools host activities such as Hispanic Heritage, Black History, and Multi-Cultural celebrations. WPS has three inter-district magnet schools; one with a multicultural and science theme, and two with an arts theme. Each magnet school draws at least 30% of its students from neighboring suburbs.

WPS participated in the yearlong SERC professional learning series: Courageous Conversations & Courageous Leadership: Moving the Racial Dialogue to Systemic Racial Equity Transformation. The district also hosted its 3rd Annual Equity Conference.

For the 2021-2022 school year, Waterbury Public Schools opened the International Dual Language School, where Native English Speakers and English Learners are learning both English and Spanish through a dual immersion model.

The Seal of Biliteracy provides recognition to English Learners (ELs) for the great value of developing English and maintaining their primary Language. WPS awarded the Seal of Biliteracy to 108 students in 12 different languages, with 9 students earning the seal in two languages.

Over the past few years, the Waterbury Public Schools' Human Capital Talent Office has increased its focus on minority teacher recruitment (MTR). Our team has been in attendance at six Historically Black Colleges & Universities (HBCU) virtual career fairs. These educator preparation programs (EPPs) have a proven record of preparing and certifying racially diverse educators. We have also attended a Diversity in Education Fair (12/8/21), Diversity in Teaching Virtual Fair (4/6/22), and the CSDE-RESC Diversity in Education Fair (5/5/22). The focus of these fairs was on MTR and as a direct result of these fairs, the number of minority candidates in our elementary and secondary talent pools increased. The state average for Teachers of Color (TOC) is approximately 10% in comparison to our district average of approximately 22% for Teachers of Color. In addition, WPS' administrator of color (AOC) rate is approximately 24%. Although we pride ourselves in having a higher average TOC and AOC rate than the state of Connecticut, we continue to diversify staff.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Waterbury School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

To allocate resources, district officials carefully weigh school and student needs against available funding, including state and federal entitlement grants. Principals have an opportunity to present budget requests for schools through their Assistant Superintendents. The district recognizes that not every school has the same needs. The Chief Academic Officer and Content Supervisors present budget requests for curriculum development or program enhancement. Some funds are allocated with district-wide impact, others are related to specific school needs and enrollment. High poverty schools or schools with special programs may need additional support, older buildings may require updates, and some schools may experience changes in student enrollment. Some schools, such as magnet schools, have access to additional funding through the State. All schools have access to additional support through competitive grants and educational partnerships. Through careful consideration of all aspects of the budget, the district is able to provide an equitable allocation of resources to all schools and all students.